The SMART Study

INVITATION FOR PARENTS AND CARERS

Will your family help find out what's best for children and phones?

Nobody knows yet the best age for a first smartphone, or how best to set one up. **[School name]** is helping to find out, as one of around 80 primary schools in the SMART Study. It runs from **September 2027** to **September 2028**, for children in **Years 3 to 5**, and we'd love your family to take part.

Will you take part?

Say yes by **[date]**: scan the QR code or go to **[web address]**. It takes about 5 minutes.

[QR code]

What taking part involves for your family

Before September 2027	Say yes, and fill in a short online survey (about **[10] minutes**).
Autumn term 2027	Your child does the first of two short reading and maths assessments (in the PIRA and PUMA format many schools already use) at school. There's nothing to prepare.
During the year	**[Two]** more short online surveys for you, about **[10] minutes** each.
Summer term 2028	Your child does the second assessment, and you fill in a last survey.

Two groups, chosen by chance. To make it a fair test, schools are split into two groups by chance. In one, families follow a simple plan until September 2028: if their child has no smartphone, they wait; if they have one, they set it up with a short list of apps and share a screen time screenshot once a month, with our step-by-step help. In the other, families carry on as usual. Everyone does the same surveys and assessments.

What you get, whichever group you're in

A [£X] voucher
After each survey you fill in.

Fun things for your child
Motivational videos, comic books and a newsletter.

What we find
A summary of what your family helped to find out.

Taking part is your choice. You can stop at any time, without giving a reason.

Questions? Ask [staff name] at school, or email smartphonestudy@public.io.

Run by IFF Research, PUBLIC and the University of Cambridge for the Department for Education.